

MALDIVES

Maldives: Key Country Details

Detail	Information
Full Name	Republic of Maldives
Short Form	Maldives
Capital	Malé
Region (UN)	Asia-Pacific Group
Government Type	Presidential Republic
President	Ibrahim Mohamed Solih (as of 2025)
Currency	Maldivian Rufiyaa (MVR)
UN Member Since	21 September 1965
Permanent UNSC Member	No
MUN Standing	Small island developing state; climate change advocate; tourism-dependent economy

Book Recommendations

Book Title	Author	Why It's Useful
Maldives: Islamic Republic, Tropical Autocracy	Xavier Romero-Frias	Cultural and political background
Climate Change and Small Island States: The Maldives	Saleemul Huq	Key insights on climate impacts and policy
The Maldives: Political Development and Challenges	Mohamed Nasheed (Editor)	Overview of governance and democratic progress
Sustainable Tourism in the Maldives	John Urry	Economic reliance on tourism and sustainability
Human Rights in the Maldives: Report and Analysis	Various NGO Reports	Status of human rights and civil liberties

Title	Link	Description
-------	------	-------------

Maldives National Report for Beijing+20 Review	Link	Maldives' comprehensive report on progress since the Beijing Declaration, highlighting national strategies for gender equality.
UN Women Asia-Pacific – Maldives	Link	Overview of UN Women's initiatives and partnerships in the Maldives to promote women's empowerment.
Maldives Statement at CSW55	Link	Official statement by the Maldives at the 55th session of the UNCSW, outlining commitments and achievements.
General Assembly Resolution on Women in Development	Link	Maldives' submission detailing activities centered around strengthening women's rights in male-dominated fields.
Comprehensive National-Level Review on the Implementation of the Beijing Declaration	Link	A detailed review of the Maldives' implementation of the Beijing Declaration and Platform for Action.
UNCSW 56th Session Overview	Link	Information on the 56th session of the UNCSW, including themes relevant to the Maldives.
(UN Women Data Hub – Country Fact Sheets)	Link	Provides gender-specific statistics and data for countries, including the Maldives.
(UN Women Global Database on Violence Against Women)	Link	Database offering information on measures taken by governments, including the Maldives, to address violence against women.
UNFPA – The Situation of Women in Maldives	Link	Report exploring women's economic empowerment and challenges in the Maldivian context.
National Gender Equality Action Plan	Link	The Maldives' action plan outlining strategies to achieve gender equality and empower women.

Women, Business and the Law 2024 – Maldives	Link	Analysis of legal barriers to women's economic empowerment in the Maldives.
UNDP – Research on Women's Access to Justice in the Maldives	Link	Study examining challenges women face in accessing justice in the Maldives.
Gender-Differentiated Consequences of COVID-19	Link	Report analyzing the impact of COVID-19 on women's employment and economic participation in the Maldives.
Paths to Equal – Twin Indices on Women's Empowerment	Link	Global report including data on the Maldives, assessing women's empowerment and gender equality.
Abortion Policies and Reproductive Health Around the World	Link	UN report providing information on abortion policies and reproductive health, including data on the Maldives.

Aspect	Description
Small Island Developing State (SIDS) Perspective	As a low-lying island nation, the Maldives really brings to light the gendered effects of climate change in all UNCSW discussions—especially how it hits women and girls in coastal and disaster-prone areas the hardest.
Strong National Gender Machinery	The Maldives, through its Ministry of Gender, Family and Social Services, has crafted well-structured national action plans that align with the goals of the UNCSW. This includes the National Gender Equality Policy for the years 2022 to 2026.
Islamic Context on Gender Rights	The Maldives, being a Muslim-majority nation, highlights how Islamic values align with the empowerment of women during discussions at the Commission on the Status of Women (CSW). They present rights in a way that is both religiously and culturally relevant.
Focus on Women's Representation in Decentralized Governance	The Maldives has been a strong advocate for getting women involved in island councils and local governance, seeing it as a crucial part of both development and democracy. This commitment sets a great example for other Small Island Developing States (SIDS).
Leadership in SIDS Gender Advocacy	The Maldives frequently stands as a voice for small island nations in regional partnerships, pushing for inclusive gender

	approaches to tackle development issues like climate resilience and sustainable tourism.
Digital Empowerment Focus	At CSW67, the Maldives highlighted the importance of closing the gender digital gap, particularly in remote atolls where women face significant barriers to accessing digital education and entrepreneurial opportunities.
Post-COVID-19 Gender Policy Integration	The Maldives showcased the importance of incorporating gender-sensitive recovery planning into their national COVID-19 response strategies. They emphasized the need to support women's reintegration into the workforce and to address issues of domestic violence prevention.
Early Legal Reform Advocacy	The Maldives has made significant changes to important laws related to gender, such as those addressing domestic violence, child rights, and sexual harassment. These reforms are in line with the UNCSW's Beijing+25 follow-up and the commitments outlined in SDG 5.
Emphasis on Male Engagement in Gender Equality	The Maldives stands out by actively involving men and boys as partners in the fight against harmful gender norms. This includes community awareness programs spearheaded by local male leaders.
Youth-Focused Gender Engagement	The Maldives is actively working to include young women in peacebuilding, policy discussions, and innovation sectors through CSW youth platforms and various side events.